



Healthy Eating

Teachers' notes

Topic: Eating a balanced diet and understanding nutritional information on food packaging

Aims:

- To develop students' ability to speed read
- To develop students' ability to talk about balanced diets
- To expand students' vocabulary for describing what food contains
- To help students read nutritional information on food packaging

Level: E3/L1

Time: 90 minutes

Tip – bring a multi-pack of small breakfast cereal boxes (empty or full) to the class. Encourage students to bring in their own empty food packaging in advance for the final task.

Introduction: This is a reading, speaking and vocabulary lesson based on the topics of balanced diets and nutritional information on food packaging. As a result, students will be more able to make healthier food choices when out shopping. The reading texts can be accessed from the NHS Choices website:

<http://www.nhs.uk/livewell/goodfood/pages/healthyeating.aspx>

Procedure

Lead-in (5 mins)

- Show photo A and elicit that the people are having dinner.
- Put students in pairs. Ask them to tell each other what they had for dinner last night.
- Elicit examples and write up on whiteboard. Check pronunciation.

Task 1 – Pre-reading (10 mins)

- Hand out student worksheet and set up task 1 by putting students in pairs.
- Tell students that they are going to read a text, but before they do, they should guess the topic by looking at the words in the word cloud.
- Monitor, elicit feedback and check pronunciation. Elicit examples of starchy foods and foods which contain protein, fibre, saturated and unsaturated fats.

Task 2 – Speaking (5 mins)

- Set up students in pairs.
- Monitor and elicit group feedback on whiteboard or similar. Check pronunciation.



Task 3 – Reading “A Balanced Diet” (15 mins)

- Access the reading text from the NHS Choices website, as indicated above.
- Tell students they have three minutes to read the text as quickly as possible. Increase the time limit if you feel three minutes is too short. They should make a note of where they read up to within the time limit.
- Tell students to read the text again for a further three minutes, starting from the beginning. Students should mark where they read up to for the second time; they should be able to read more each time. Repeat if students enjoy.
- Tell students to read the text again and now make notes about what makes a balanced diet.

Task 4 – Speaking (5 mins)

- Put students in pairs again.
- Monitor and elicit group feedback, focusing on any new information students have learned since reading the text about ‘A Balanced Diet’. Check pronunciation.

Task 5 – Making a poster – In class for extension or homework

- Set up students in small groups to design a poster about ‘A Balanced Diet’ in order to consolidate information and vocabulary from the reading.
- If students prefer, they could design an online poster at: <http://www.glogster.com/>
- If students prefer, they can write the information as a text, rather than on a poster.

Task 6 – Vocabulary (the substances that food contains) (10 mins)

- With the concept of a balanced diet now established, students are ready to develop their vocabulary further, regarding the substances that food contains.
- Set students up in pairs to complete Task 6.
- Monitor and elicit feedback. Check pronunciation and tell students to mark word stress on all the words.

Suggested answers: All these substances can be found in food.

a: carbohydrates b: saturated fat c: unsaturated fat d: fibre e: salt f: protein g: sugar

Task 7 – Complete the table (5 mins)

- Students complete the table individually. Monitor spelling and pronunciation.

Task 8 – Speaking (5 mins)

- Put students in pairs. Elicit ways to complete examples e.g. it contains/is high/low in.
- Monitor and elicit group feedback. You could also elicit health problems caused by eating too much fat etc e.g. obesity. Check pronunciation and word stress.



Task 9 – Reading “Nutritional labels” (10 mins)

- In pairs, students look at the photograph of a nutritional label which appears on the back of some food packaging.
- Students discuss the questions before reading the text to check.
- Set up the reading with a time limit. Allow two minutes for students to read the text individually before they move back into their pair.
- The pair with the quickest correct answer is the winner.
- Elicit student opinions about whether the food on the food label is healthy or not.

Suggested answer: It's low in total fat (less than 3g/100g), low in saturated fat (less than 1.5g/100g), low in sugar (less than 5g/100g), quite low in sodium (0.26g/100g). Look at sodium rather than 'equivalent salt'. Sodium is the part of salt that causes health problems.

Task 10 – Speaking to compare different foods (15 mins)

- Hand out one item of food packaging (such as breakfast cereal box) to each student.
- Tell students to locate the nutritional information on their packaging.
- Monitor as students speak. Listen for use of comparative/superlative structures. Review if necessary.
- Set up the final group task where students line up all the food packaging according to how much salt/fat etc they contain. Decide as a group which are the healthiest and unhealthiest foods.

Photo A

